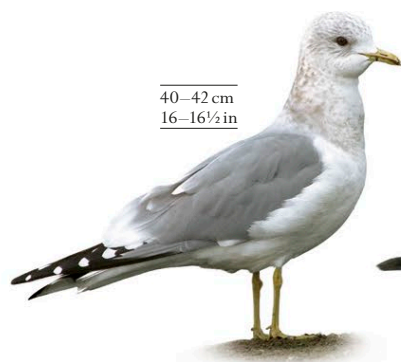




40–42 cm
16–16½ in

MEW GULL
Larus canus
F: Laridae

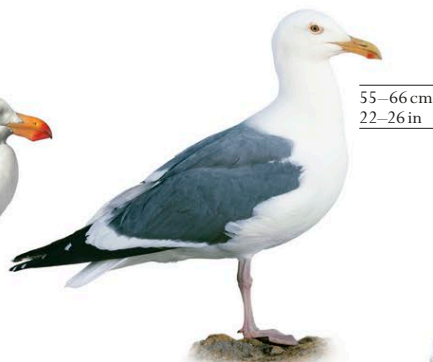
This northern hemisphere species, whose name derives from its distinctive call, is also called the common gull. It breeds inland on moors, as well as on the coast.



50–67 cm
20–26 in

PACIFIC GULL
Larus pacificus
F: Laridae

Belonging to a group of southern gulls with banded tails, this large-billed Australian species cracks open shellfish by dropping them on rocks.



55–66 cm
22–26 in

WESTERN GULL
Larus occidentalis
F: Laridae

This large gull is found on the Pacific coast of N. America. It nests in colonies, usually offshore on islands or rocks.



large
white head

slaty black back
and wings

64–78 cm
25–31 in

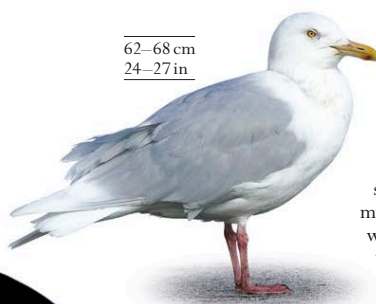
pink feet

**GREAT
BLACK-BACKED GULL**
Larus marinus
F: Laridae

The world's largest gull, this North Atlantic coastal bird is an aggressive predator and preys on other seabirds and their chicks.

**GREAT
BLACK-HEADED GULL**
Ichthyaeus ichthyaeus
F: Laridae

One member of an Asian group of black-headed gulls, this species breeds in Russia and overwinters on Mediterranean and Indian ocean coasts. It is also known as Pallas's gull.



62–68 cm
24–27 in

GLAUCOUS GULL
Larus hyperboreus
F: Laridae

A large, Arctic-breeding species, this coastal gull is much paler than most related white-headed gulls found in the northern hemisphere.



46–51 cm
18–20 in

RING-BILLED GULL
Larus delawarensis
F: Laridae

Breeding in N. America and overwintering in the Caribbean, this species has a dark bill ring. It often forages on agricultural land.



57–61 cm
22½–24 in

tricoloured bill

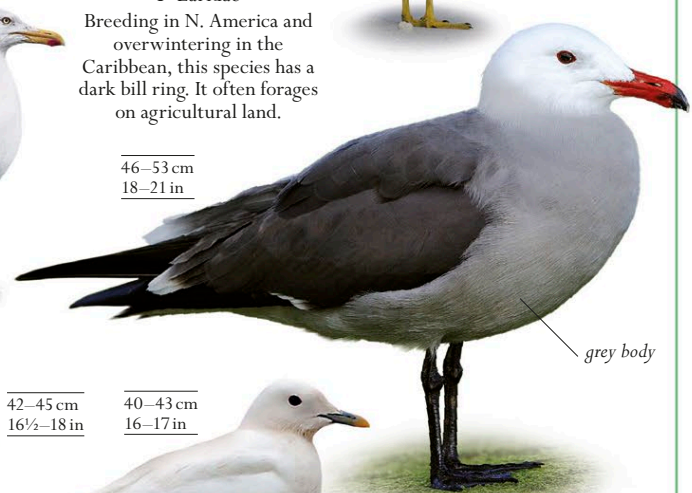
white-edged
eye



52–60 cm
20½–23½ in

HERRING GULL
Larus argentatus
F: Laridae

Related to the lesser black-backed gull (*L. fuscus*), this species is often seen in coastal towns in Europe and eastern N. America.



46–53 cm
18–21 in

grey body

HEERMANN'S GULL
Larus heermanni
F: Laridae

This dark gull from N. America is actually related to northern white-headed gulls. It often forages with brown pelicans and steals their food.



42–45 cm
16½–18 in

SOOTY GULL
Ichthyaeus hemprichii
F: Laridae

As with many warm-region gulls, this species from Asia and Africa has dark plumage, which may have evolved as an adaptation to strong sunshine.



40–43 cm
16–17 in

IVORY GULL
Pagophila eburnea
F: Laridae

This Arctic gull is rarely found far from pack ice. It follows polar bears to scavenge at their kills.



39–43 cm
15½–17 in

WHITE-EYED GULL
Ichthyaeus leucophthalmus
F: Laridae

This relative of the sooty gull is confined to the Red Sea region, where it is threatened by oil spills.



35–40 cm
14–16 in

RED-LEGGED KITTIWAKE
Rissa brevirostris
F: Laridae

This kittiwake breeds only on islands in the Bering Sea in the North Pacific and spends winter at sea further south.



38–40 cm
15–16 in

BLACK-LEGGED KITTIWAKE
Rissa tridactyla
F: Laridae

The world's most abundant species of gull, this colonial cliff-nesting bird is found in the North Atlantic and Pacific oceans.